NINETY SIX WILDCATS

BRAND GUIDELINES

VERSION 1.1

Brand Overview

The Ninety Six Wildcats identity is a small set of logos built from one typeface family, one slant, and two colors. It's designed to work the same on a hallway TV, a phone, a shirt, and a printed page.



Building blocks

WILDCATS	Saira Condensed Black, slanted, with a few custom adjustments.
NINETY SIX	The town and school name, set smaller above WILDCATS.
The 96 box	The school's number in a slanted box. Used as the icon and for team logos.
The slant	Every logo and graphic panel leans at the same angle: 6.84 degrees.
Maroon and cream	The two school colors. Black and white for one-color printing.

Principles

- Use the supplied logo files. Don't retype or redraw the logos.
- One color per logo, with strong contrast against the background.
- Keep it simple: no mascots, paw prints, shields, outlines, shadows, or extra logos.

Brand Architecture

The school has two levels of identity. Use the Wildcats logos for anything about school spirit. Use the Ninety Six High School name for official and academic material.





Wildcats identity

- Athletics and team graphics
- School spirit, events, and student activities
- School TVs and social media
- Apparel and merchandise
- Posters and flyers

Ninety Six High School

- Official letters and notices
- Forms and administrative communication
- Academic materials
- Graduation programs and diplomas
- Formal correspondence

Rules

- The Ninety Six High School mark is set upright in Saira Bold. It does not use the slant, the athletic lettering, or slant panels.
- Formal documents may include the 96 icon small, but never a WILDCATS logo.
- Don't place the two identities side by side as equals. Pick the one that fits the audience.

Primary Marks

Use one of these two logos whenever possible.



Primary logo

Use for TV slides, posters, signs, and the back of shirts.

Minimum width: 1.5 in (240 px)



Horizontal logo

Use when space is short or narrow, such as web headers, letterhead, and small merchandise.

Minimum width: 1 in (110 px)

Secondary Marks



Stacked logo

Use in square spaces, social media posts, and on the back of shirts. NINETY SIX is set in Saira Condensed Black, stretched to the width of WILDCATS.

Minimum width: 1 in (140 px)



Icon

Use for profile pictures, website icons, sleeves, and stickers.

Minimum width: 0.3 in (32 px)



Wordmark

Use when 96 already appears nearby or space is very limited.

Minimum width: 0.8 in (80 px)

Logo Construction: Primary

All measurements are ratios of C, the cap height of WILDCATS, so the logo can be rebuilt at any size. Use the supplied files; this page is for reference and quality checks.

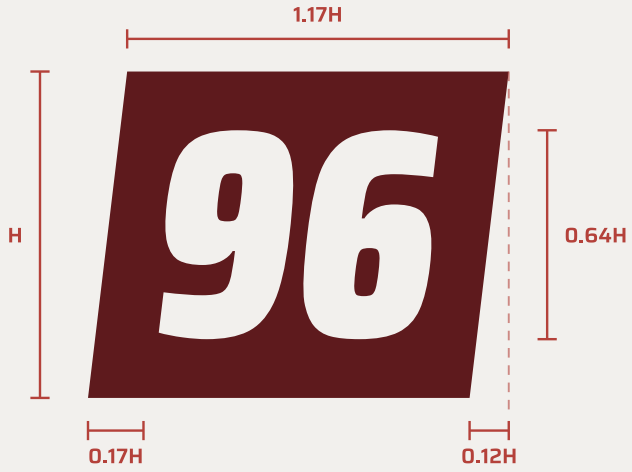


Dashed lines: rail ends line up with the top corners of W and S

Element	Specification
Slant	Whole logo sheared 0.12 (6.84 degrees), leaning right
WILDCATS	Saira Condensed Black, tracking +20/1000 em, custom A (see next page)
NINETY SIX	Saira ExtraBold (width 110), tracking +220/1000 em, height 0.24C
NINETY SIX position	0.19C above WILDCATS, centered between the rail ends
Rails	Weight 0.073C (same as NINETY SIX strokes), 0.19C from NINETY SIX
Overall size	5.43C wide by 1.44C tall

Logo Construction: 96 Box

The 96 box is the same shape everywhere: in the icon, the horizontal logo, and every team logo. Only its size changes. H is the height of the box.





In the horizontal and team logos, the box is as tall as the lettering (H = C) and sits 0.17C from it, baselines aligned.

Element	Specification
Box	Width 1.17H, height H, same 0.12 slant as the lettering
Numerals	Saira Condensed Black, 0.64H tall, 0.17H from each side, centered
Horizontal logo	Box height = C. Box sits 0.17C left of WILDCATS, baselines aligned
Icon	The box on its own. Width 1.29H including the slant
Spacing pairs	L-D -35, D-C -10, C-A -10, T-S -15 (1/1000 em)
Custom A	Opened counter: flat top 0.073C wide, so the A doesn't fill in when small

Team and Group Logos

Teams, clubs, and groups use the horizontal logo with their name in place of WILDCATS. Files for each team are in logos/teams. To add a group, follow these rules.

One word	One line. Box height = C.
Two or more words	Two lines. Split where the two lines come out closest in length.
Line spacing	0.26C between lines. Box height = 2.26C, so it matches both lines.
Ampersand	Use &, not "and". It stays at the end of the first line (TRACK & / FIELD).
Long names	No line may be longer than 7C (about 1.3x WILDCATS). If it is, use the group's usual initials.
Abbreviations	Only when a name is too long. All caps, no periods (NHS, FBLA, FFA).
Short names	Allowed as they are (GOLF, NHS). The box doesn't change.
Teams and clubs	Same construction for both. The name is the only difference.
Levels	JV, varsity, boys, and girls are not part of the logo. Put them in nearby text.



Team Logo Examples

All examples use one size of lettering. National Honor Society is too long for two lines, so it uses its initials.



















National Honor Society → NHS

Clear Space

Keep other text, images, and page edges at least x away from every logo. For the icon and team logos, x is half the height of the box.



Primary logo: x = 0.5C (half the height of WILDCATS)



Icon and team logos: x = 0.5H



Horizontal: x = 0.5C

Minimum Sizes

Below these widths, the thinnest gaps in the logo (between C and A, and between 9 and 6) close up. Screen sizes were checked on screen. Print sizes are calculated; apparel sizes are planning values to confirm with a test print or sew-out.

Logo	Screen	Print	Screen print	Vinyl	Embroidery
Primary	240 px	1.5 in	4.5 in	6 in	Not advised
Horizontal	110 px	1 in	3.75 in	5 in	6 in
Stacked	140 px	1 in	3.25 in	4.25 in	5 in
Wordmark	80 px	0.8 in	3 in	4 in	4.75 in
Icon	32 px	0.3 in	0.75 in	1 in	1.25 in

Changes from v1.0

- Horizontal logo: print minimum raised from 0.75 in to 1 in.
- Wordmark: print minimum raised from 0.6 in to 0.8 in.
- Apparel minimums are new. On a left chest (about 3.5 in wide), use the icon, or test the wordmark with a sew-out first.
- Screen minimums were tested and stay the same.

Shown at actual print size (print this page at 100%)



1.5 in



1 in



1 in



0.8 in



0.3 in

Test sheets: production-tests/screen-size-test.png and print-and-apparel-size-tests.pdf

Colors

Maroon and cream are the school colors. Black and white are for one-color printing. The gradient is for TV screens and other digital backgrounds only.



Maroon
#5E1A1D
RGB 94, 26, 29

Cream
#F5EAD5
RGB 245, 234, 213

Black
#000000
RGB 0, 0, 0

White
#FFFFFF
RGB 255, 255, 255

TV gradient
#973333 top
#320B0B bottom

Contrast

Combination	Contrast ratio	Use
Cream on maroon	10.7 : 1	Yes, the main combination
Maroon on cream or white	10.7 / 12.8 : 1	Yes
Cream or white on TV gradient	6.2 : 1 at the lightest point	Yes, for logos and text
Maroon on TV gradient	1.7 : 1	No
Maroon on black	1.6 : 1	No
Cream on white	1.2 : 1	No

Print color

CMYK and Pantone values haven't been set yet. Before the first large print or apparel order, have the printer match maroon and cream to a physical sample (a printed proof or a fabric swatch), then add the approved values to this page. Don't guess them from the screen colors.

Typography

Everything uses the Saira family, which is free on Google Fonts and works in Google Docs, Slides, and Canva. The logos are artwork; never recreate them by typing.

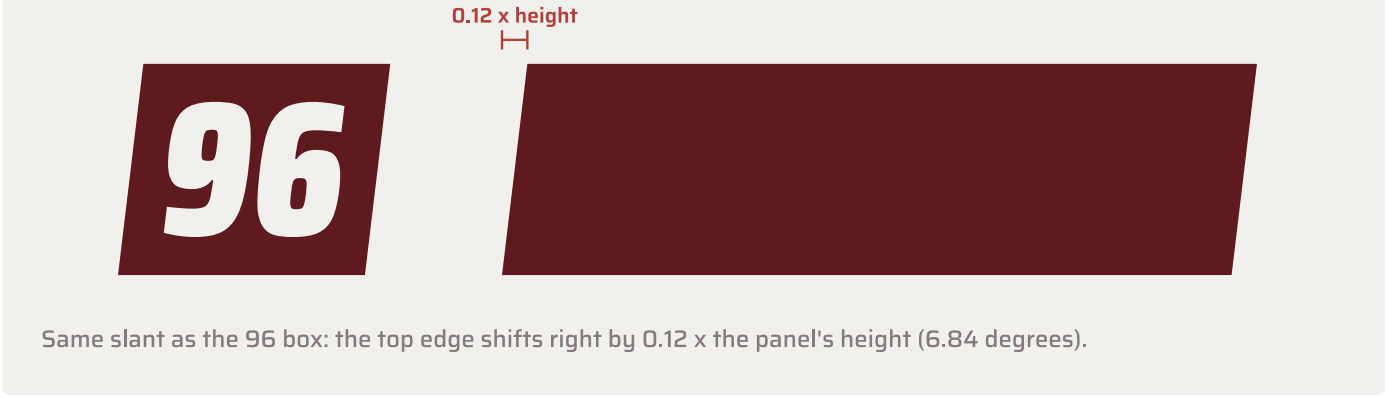
Display headline	**GAME DAY** Saira Condensed Black, all caps, line spacing 0.9
Section heading	**Fall Schedule** Saira Bold, title case
Body text	Practice starts Monday at 3:30 in the main gym. Saira Regular, 10 to 12 pt, line spacing 1.4
Labels and details	**FRIDAY · 7:30 PM · HOME** Saira SemiBold, all caps, letter spacing +12%

Logo type (for reference only)

- WILDCATS, 96, and team names: Saira Condensed Black, slanted 6.84 degrees, with custom spacing and a modified A.
- NINETY SIX in the primary logo: Saira ExtraBold at width 110 (only available in the variable font).
- Headlines in layouts stay upright. The slant belongs to the logos and the slant panels.

Slant Panels

Slant panels are the one graphic device in the identity. They're parallelograms at the same angle as the 96 box, so layouts feel like Ninety Six Wildcats even when the logo is small.



Same slant as the 96 box: the top edge shifts right by 0.12 x the panel's height (6.84 degrees).



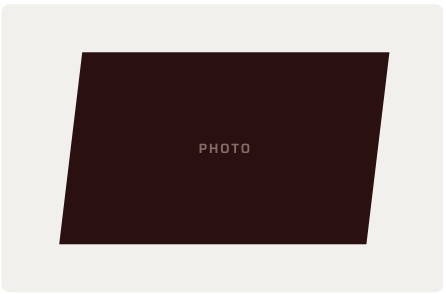
Tag

Small panel holding a short label: a date, a time, GAME DAY. Text is upright, cap height half the panel's height.



Band

A wide panel that runs off one or both page edges. Holds a logo or a footer line.



Frame

A photo container. The photo fills the panel; never add a border.

Rules

- Always lean right at 6.84 degrees. Never rotate, flip, or round the corners.
- Solid maroon, cream, black, or white, or a photo. No outlines, gradients, or shadows.
- Up to three panels per layout. Don't use panels on formal documents.

Digital and TV

Hallway TVs are read from a distance and for only a few seconds. Keep slides short and large.



Dashed line: 5% safe area

- Size 1920 x 1080 px. Use the TV gradient (#973333 to #320B0B) or solid maroon.
- Keep all text and logos inside the 5% safe area; some TVs crop the edges.
- Cream or white text only. Headlines at least 120 px, details at least 40 px.
- One message per slide: a headline, one line of details, at most one sentence.
- The horizontal logo sits small in the bottom left. Don't repeat it in the headline.
- Blank backgrounds are in templates/tv-slide.

Social Media

Use the same panels, type, and colors as the TV slides. Team accounts use their own team logo and profile picture.



Post 1080 x 1080



Story 1080 x 1920



Schedule 1080 x 1350



Profile pictures

- Keep text out of the top and bottom 250 px of stories, where the app covers it.
- Profile pictures use the icon, or the team's square logo. Never the full primary logo.
- Schedules: cream date tags for home games, black for away. One team logo per graphic.

Print and Apparel



Poster 11 x 17 in



Letterhead 8.5 x 11 in



T-shirt concept

Print

- Use the PDF or SVG logo files. PNGs are for screens and documents only.
- Use 0.25 in or more of margin on anything that's trimmed.

Apparel

- Print in one ink color: maroon or cream on the shirt color, or white or black.
- Left chest (about 3.5 in): the icon. Full front or back: the primary or stacked logo, 10 to 12 in wide.
- Check minimum sizes for the method (screen print, vinyl, embroidery) and ask the vendor for a proof or sew-out. Test artwork is in production-tests.

Do's and Don'ts



Do use the supplied logo files.



Don't stretch, squash, or re-slant the logo.



Do use the horizontal logo in small or narrow spaces.



Don't add outlines, shadows, or other effects.



Do use the icon for profile pictures and square spaces.



Don't type the logo out in a font.



Do use the team logo files for teams and clubs.



Don't use maroon on the gradient, or other low-contrast pairs.

Files and Naming

Every logo comes in maroon, cream, black, and white, as SVG, PDF, and PNG. File names follow one pattern so they're easy to find.

ninety-six-wildcats-brand/

logos/primary/	wildcats-primary-<color>.svg, .pdf, .png
logos/horizontal/	wildcats-horizontal-<color>
logos/stacked/	wildcats-stacked-<color>
logos/wordmark/	wildcats-wordmark-<color>
logos/icon/	wildcats-icon-<color>
logos/teams/<team>/	wildcats-team-<team>-<horizontal or square>-<color>
logos/institutional/	ninetysix-hs-<line or stacked>-<color>
social/profile/	wildcats-profile-<variant>.png
templates/<template>/	wildcats-<template>-<example or blank>.png
production-tests/	Size test sheets
guidelines/	This document, page images, and the v1.1 audit
fonts/	Saira font files and licenses
source/	Scripts that rebuild every file

Format	Use for
SVG	Websites, Canva, Google Slides, and sending to vendors
PDF	Printing, sign shops, and apparel vendors
PNG	Documents, slides, and social media (transparent background)

Color names in files: maroon, cream, black, white. Team names are lowercase with hyphens (cross-country, track-and-field).